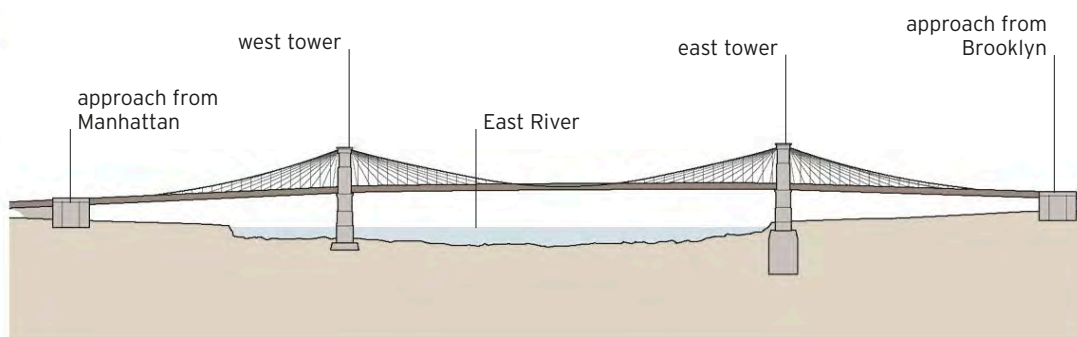




BUILDING THE TOWERS

The twin Neo-Gothic towers of the Brooklyn Bridge stand 277 ft (84.3m) above the water and are built of limestone, granite, and Rosendale cement, a natural cement produced in New York since 1825. They were built by floating two caissons—huge upside-down pine boxes—into position and then

building the stone towers on top of them until they sank to the bottom. Compressed air was then pumped into the caissons to allow workers to dig out the sediment until the caissons sank down to the bedrock, where they were filled in with brick piers and concrete.



△ PEDESTRIAN WALKWAY

The bridge's cables form an intriguing weblike pattern that is best seen from the shared pedestrian and cycle path.